



Overseas woes The Dubai Financial Services Authority barred HDFC Bank's DIFC branch in September 2025 from conducting business with new customers

will meet in the “near future” and take a call on Jagdishan’s future. In the backdrop of the recent developments, the RBI may also look harder before taking a call on his reappointment, say industry executives.

One key executive expected to play a larger role going ahead is deputy managing director Kaizad Bharucha. Bharucha, also 60, has been with the bank since its inception in 1995 and is the longest serving executive board member. Bharucha oversees corporate banking, emerging corporates group, business banking—working capital, investment banking, and rural banking group, among other things. “He will get more responsi-

bilities as we move forward,” says Jagdishan.

Prakhar Sharma, an analyst at Jefferies, says clarity on board issues, rollover of the CEO’s term and appointment of chairman could lead to a rerating of HDFC Bank shares. Ankit Bihani, an analyst at Nomura, agrees. “Governance uncertainty and leadership visibility gap are likely to keep the stock under pressure,” he says.

A senior banking industry executive says stability is important. “You need to ensure management continuity. Also, as a depositor, as a stakeholder, as a market participant, you want complete clarity around the issues raised,” he says.

For now, analysts remain confident that HDFC Bank remains financially strong. For now, analysts remain confident that HDFC Bank remains financially strong and following the fall in the price find valuations attractive. Jefferies, for instance, sees it as a top pick in the sector following the sharp fall in the price making valuations attractive.

HDFC Bank will announce its earnings for the fourth quarter on April 18. The commentary around the top management will be closely watched to see if the bank is still a worthy of its solid legacy. **BT**

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